

Welcome to the Employability Skills Development Module

5 TOPICS, 12 SESSIONS OVER 12 WEEKS

Module Essentials

Objective : The Aim of this module is to provide students with an exposure of what is required to practice in the industry as an IT graduate.

Audience : The lectures are for the students of year 3, semester 1 from all locations.

GPA/Credits : This is a Non GPA but Compulsory (1 CREDIT) module offered to all students following the four year degree.

Assessment Criteria : 70% from In-Class tests (at the end of each session), 30% from Assignment.

Attendance Requirement : Minimum of 10 out of 12 sessions (full session attendance).

Delivery Mode : Online.

Breakdown of Sessions

1. Types of soft skills needed in the industry
2. Application of soft skills in different environments
3. Domination of different soft skills according to the situation
4. Similarities and differences between academic and industrial environments
5. Differences between students and employees
6. Types of job roles available in the local and global market
7. Elaboration of job roles in the IT hemisphere
8. New tools being introduced to the industry
9. Elaboration of how these tools work together in the IT hemisphere
10. What is Professionalism?
11. Value Systems
12. How Ethics, Values, & Professionalism Work Together in the Industrial Context

Introduction



Bimal Gunapala

Senior Academic Fellow

At SLIIT, I am focused on industry engagements and enabling students for internship and employability through various initiatives.

30 years of experience in the industry, leading engineering, delivery and operations of organizations such as Hitachi, LSEG, Pearson and Wiley.

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Presenters



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Chief Executive Office, Hrock Digital

Types of Soft (Human) Skills needed in the Industry

EMPLOYABILITY SKILLS DEVELOPMENT SEMINAR SERIES

TOPIC 1, SUBTOPIC 1



Introduction to Soft Skills

- Soft skills are non-technical skills that relate to how you work.
- They include how you interact with colleagues, solve problems, and manage your work.
- Essential for workplace success and career growth.

Importance in the Industrial Context

- Employers value soft skills as much as technical skills.
- Soft skills enhance collaboration, communication, and adaptability.
- Crucial for team-based and client-facing roles.

Categories of Soft Skills

- Communication
- Teamwork
- Adaptability
- Problem-solving
- Emotional Intelligence

Teamwork

- Collaboration with diverse teams
- Supporting team goals
- Conflict resolution
- Respecting different perspectives



Adaptability



- Embracing change
- Flexibility in roles and responsibilities
- Learning new tools and technologies
- Coping with uncertainty
- Staying positive under pressure
- Focus on solutions

Problem-Solving

- Analytical thinking
- Decision-making under pressure
- Creative solutions
- Root cause analysis

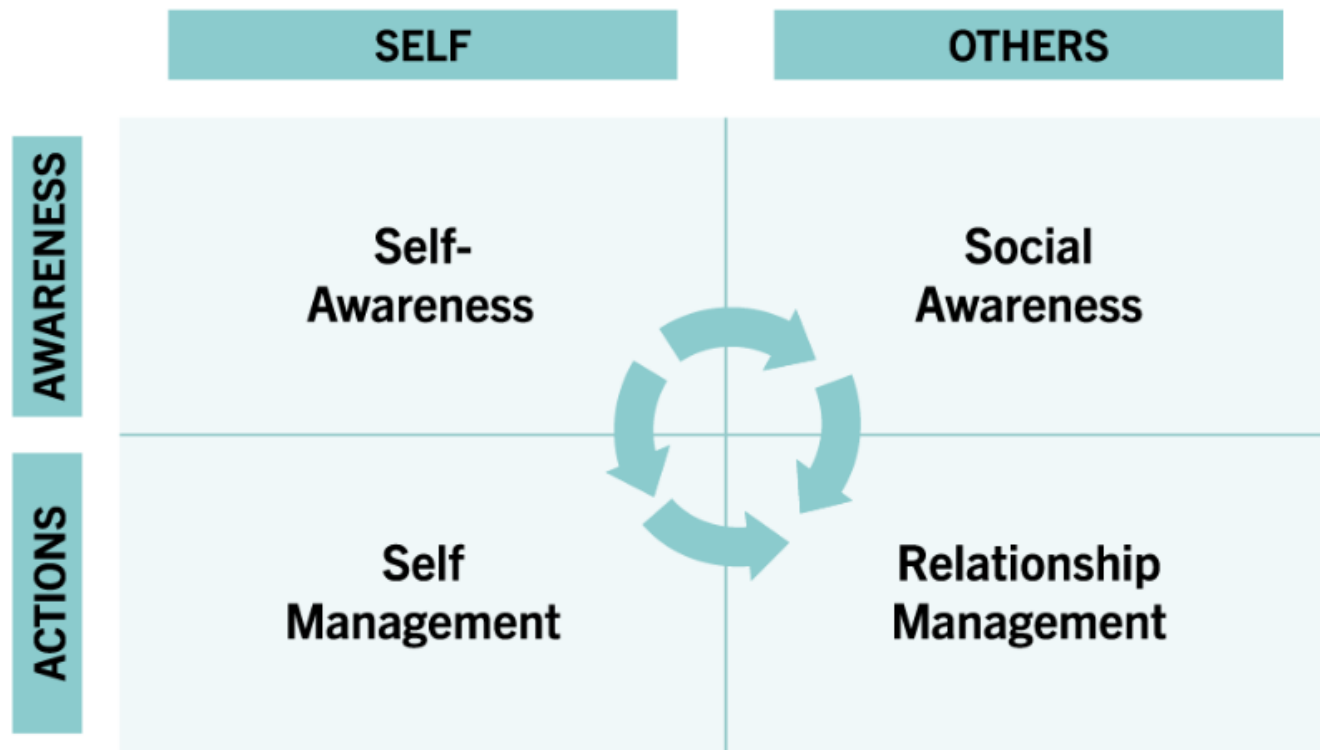


Emotional Intelligence

- Self-awareness and self-regulation
- Empathy and social skills
- Managing interpersonal relationships
- Handling workplace stress

Emotional Intelligence

4 core competencies



Different Types of Intelligence



Intelligence Quotient (IQ)

The measure of your “comprehension ability”, to solve math problems, memorize things and recall subject matter



Emotional Quotient (EQ)

The measure of your ability to maintain peace with others, respect boundaries, keep to time, responsible, honest, humble, genuine, and considerate



Social Quotient (SQ)

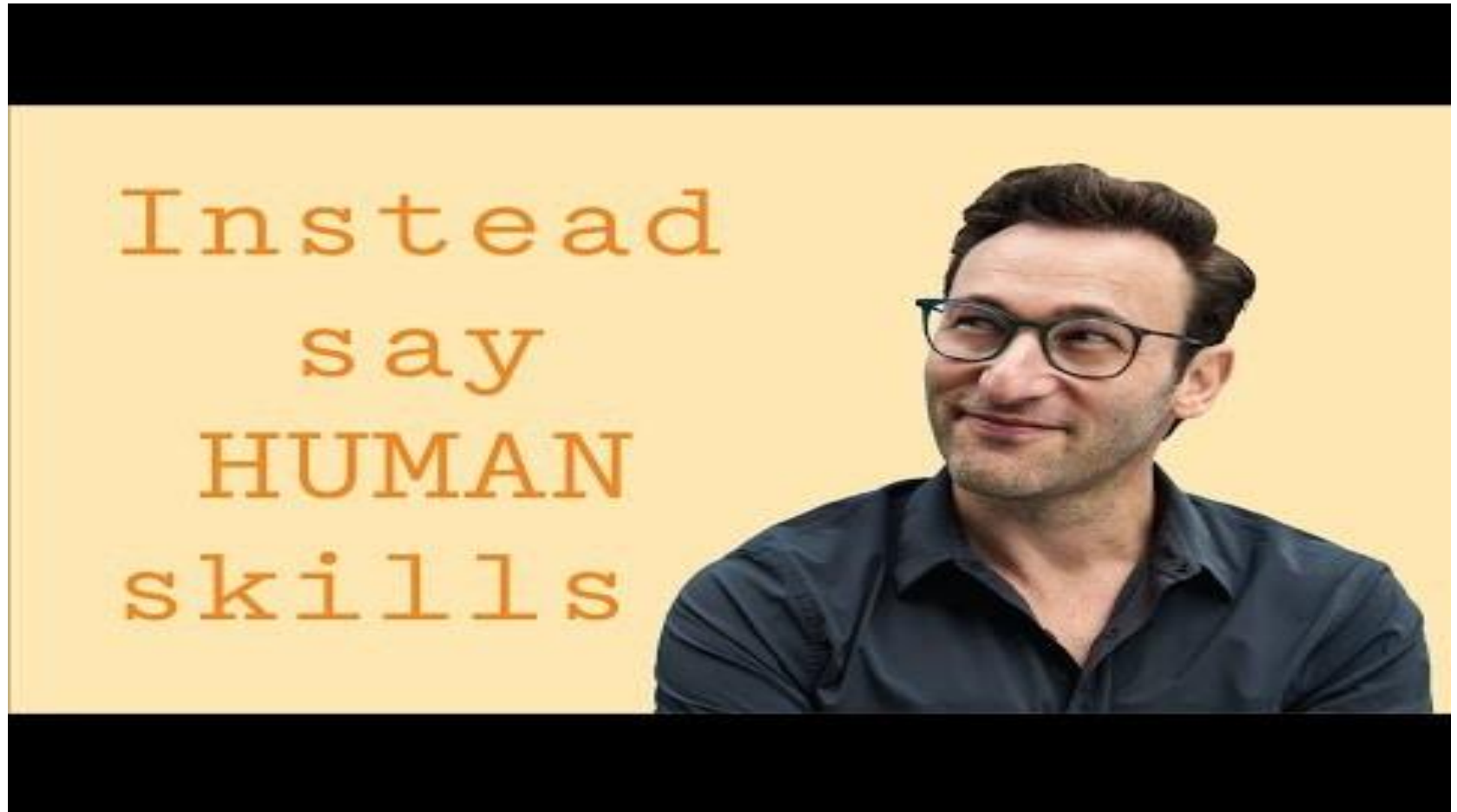
The measure of your ability to build a network of friends and maintain it over a long period of time



Adversity Quotient (AQ)

The measure of your ability to go through a rough patch in life and come out without losing your mind.

Empathy in action...



Soft Skills Relevance to IT Industry

- IT professionals often work in teams and with clients.
- Soft skills improve project outcomes and client satisfaction.
- Essential for leadership and management roles.

Examples in Practice

- A developer presenting a project to stakeholders.
- A support engineer resolving a customer issue with empathy.
- A team lead managing conflict during a sprint.

Soft Skills vs Hard Skills

- Hard skills: Technical abilities (e.g., coding, database management).
- Soft/Human skills: Interpersonal and cognitive abilities.
- Both are essential for career success.

Developing Soft Skills

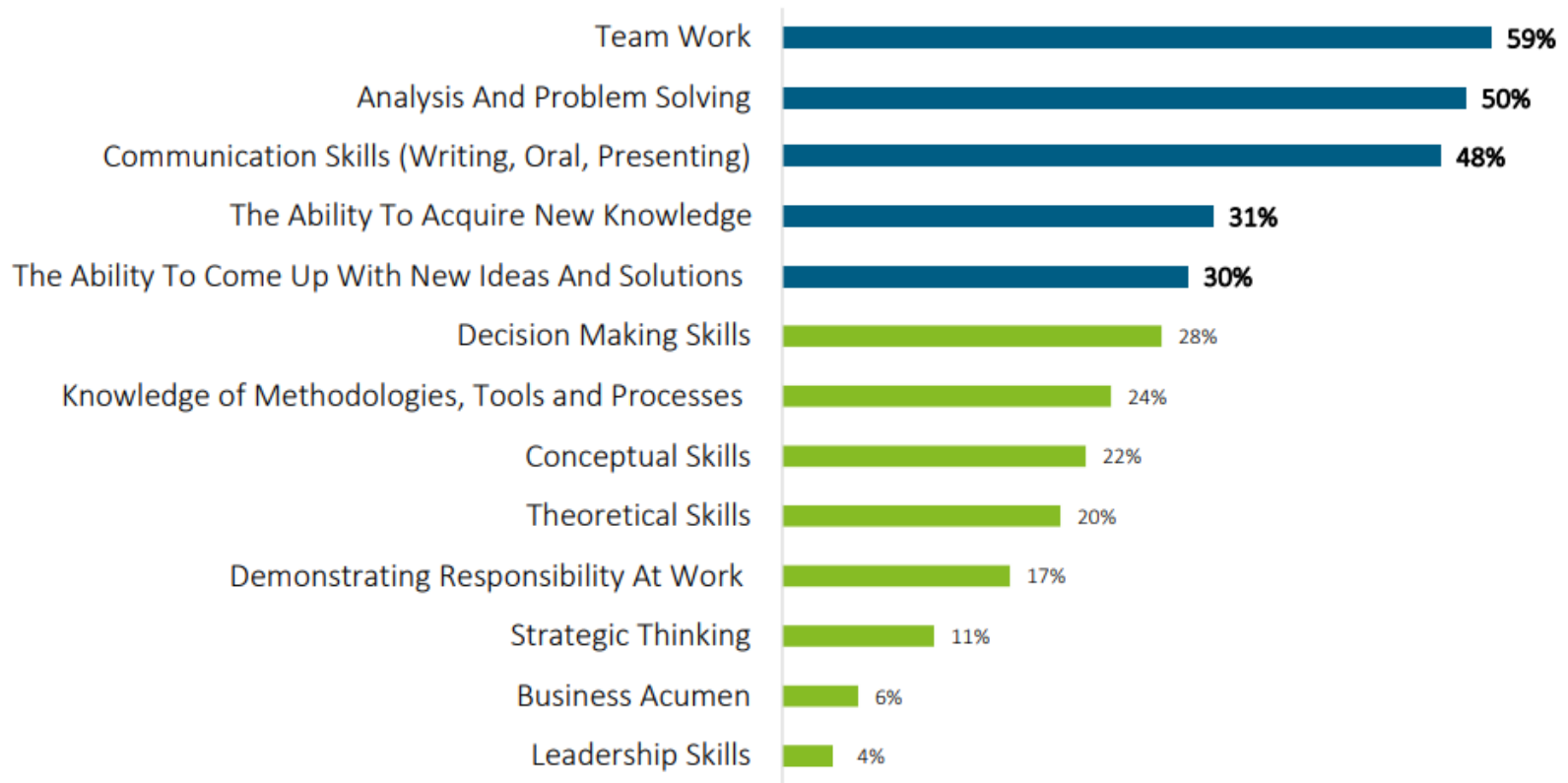
- Practice active listening and communication.
- Participate in team projects and group discussions.
- Seek feedback and reflect on interactions.
- Attend workshops and training sessions.

Industry Expectations

- Employers expect graduates to be job-ready.
- Soft skills are often evaluated during interviews.
- Demonstrating soft skills can set candidates apart.

Official word from SL Industry

MOST IMPORTANT SKILLS EXPECTED FROM THE HIRES BASED ON EMPLOYER PRIORITY, FROM NEW GRADUATE HIRES.



Source: SLAASSCOM Employability Skills Report 2024

Discussion Prompt

- Think of a time when your soft skills helped you succeed.
- How do you plan to improve your soft skills before graduation?
- What soft skill do you think is most important in IT?

Summary

- Soft skills are critical for success in the workplace.
- Key types include communication, teamwork, adaptability, problem-solving, and emotional intelligence.
- Developing these skills enhances employability and career growth.

Q&A

- Any questions or thoughts – your perspectives on soft skills?

Be the best you could be...

